ONTARIO FOI | PROCESS DESIGN CASE STUDY

Current-State vs. Proposed Future-State Process Map

Illustrative branch workflow | Based on Ontario FOI Performance Review & Branch RIM Toolkit (2023-2025)

CURRENT STATE (ILLUSTRATIVE)

Conceptual baseline, not an observed ministry workflow

1
Receive request
Request arrives; intake information may vary.

→

2
Log and assign
Manual tracking and ownership handoff.

→

3
Locate records
Search across branches and record locations.

→

4
Review and consult
Exemptions, privacy and third-party review.

→

5
Decide and close
Issue response; retain evidence of search.

Potential friction points inferred from the policy brief (not verified internal failures):

Uneven intake demand | Delayed retrieval of complex files | Search documentation gaps | Deadline / extension tracking risk

PROPOSED FUTURE STATE

Illustrative standardized design for a hypothetical branch

1
Register request
Use consistent intake fields and a unique case ID.

→

2
Triage and assign
Set owner, scope and deadline checkpoints.

→

3
Assess fees / plan
Document estimates, pauses and staged access if relevant.

→

4
Search by file plan
Use 14-series classification and structured search log.

→

5
Collect and verify
Track record holders, locations and search completeness.

6
Review exemptions
Document privacy, legal and third-party considerations.

→

7
Quality check
Check search evidence, redactions and decision basis.

→

8
Approve response
Record sign-off and applicable notices.

→

9
Release and close
Issue decision, update tracker and archive evidence.

DESIGN CONTROLS

14-series file plan • Search log • Retention crosswalk • Training checklist • Deadline / status tracking

Proposed monitoring: statutory timeliness, no-record outcomes, reasonable-search appeals, overdue cases and training completion.

Evidence from source brief: 2025 provincial 30-day completion rate 71.2%; no-responsive-record outcomes 22%; deemed-refusal and reasonable-search issues together 28% of 2025 access appeal issues (combined jurisdictions).

Source: Yuxin (Cindy) Wang, Ontario Ministry FOI Performance Review & Branch RIM Toolkit, 2023-2025, pp. 4-5.

Conceptual design only. No implementation, measured time savings or actual government workflow is claimed.